PUBLIC COMMENT — ARDEN STATE CHAMBER OF COMMERCE

Submitted 15 April 2025

The Chamber does not take a position on the environmental purposes of the bill.

The Chamber's concern is the signal. Arden competes for investment with neighbouring states. In the Chamber's most recent survey of members, 38 per cent named regulatory predictability among their three most important siting factors, ahead of corporate tax rate. A charge computed on transactions completed years earlier is the opposite of predictable.

The Chamber's members employ 244,659 people in Arden across all sectors. The Chamber's board voted 9 to 2 to submit this comment.

The Chamber notes that the tourism sector, which accounts for approximately $11,640 million of state industry revenue, depends on the coastal amenities the fund is intended to protect, and that a number of Chamber members in that sector support the bill for that reason.

The Chamber asks that any charge be prospective and that the Legislature give affected businesses a full fiscal year's notice.

Submitted on behalf of the Chamber's Government Affairs Committee.